

Zed Poirier

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Kitchener, Ontario, Canada

SUMMARY

Senior Technical Artist and real-time VFX Specialist focused on gameplay clarity, shader systems, and performant visual effects across evolving engine workflows.

- Technical Art Focused
- Shader Wizardry
- Rapid Gameplay Prototyping
- VR & Mobile Development
- Real Time Visual Effects
- Bilingual (English & French)

SKILLS

Languages & Engines: Unity, Unreal, Godot, C#, HLSL, GLSL, C++, Python

Art Software: Blender, Maya, Substance Suite, Adobe Suite

Production: Jira, Trello, GitHub, SVN, Google Drive

EXPERIENCE

Technical Artist - June 2024 to January 2026

Cloudhead Games - Remote Contract

- Authored bespoke real-time shaders and gameplay-driven particle effects that improved player feedback, visual clarity, and immersion across interactive systems.
- Quickly adapted VFX workflows to fit ever evolving production needs and technical constraints in a dynamic team.

Technical Artist - July 2021 to July 2024

Boss Music Games - Remote Contract

- Partnered closely with design and art stakeholders to solve visual clarity challenges, delivering budget-conscious solutions that improved gameplay feedback without compromising style or runtime performance.
- Designed and implemented gameplay VFX that strengthened combat readability, impact timing, and moment-to-moment player response, with careful attention to performance budgets and iteration speed.

Technical Artist - May 2021 to August 2023

Shine Spark Entertainment - Remote Contract

- Developed a custom toon lighting system using Unity render pipeline features to support stylized visual direction while maintaining flexibility for gameplay needs.
- Integrated art assets, shaders, and lighting workflows to build visually cohesive environments, improving scene readability and overall production efficiency.

EDUCATION

- **CS50x Certificate, 2020**, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA
- **Game Design Diploma, 2020**, Conestoga College, Kitchener, ON